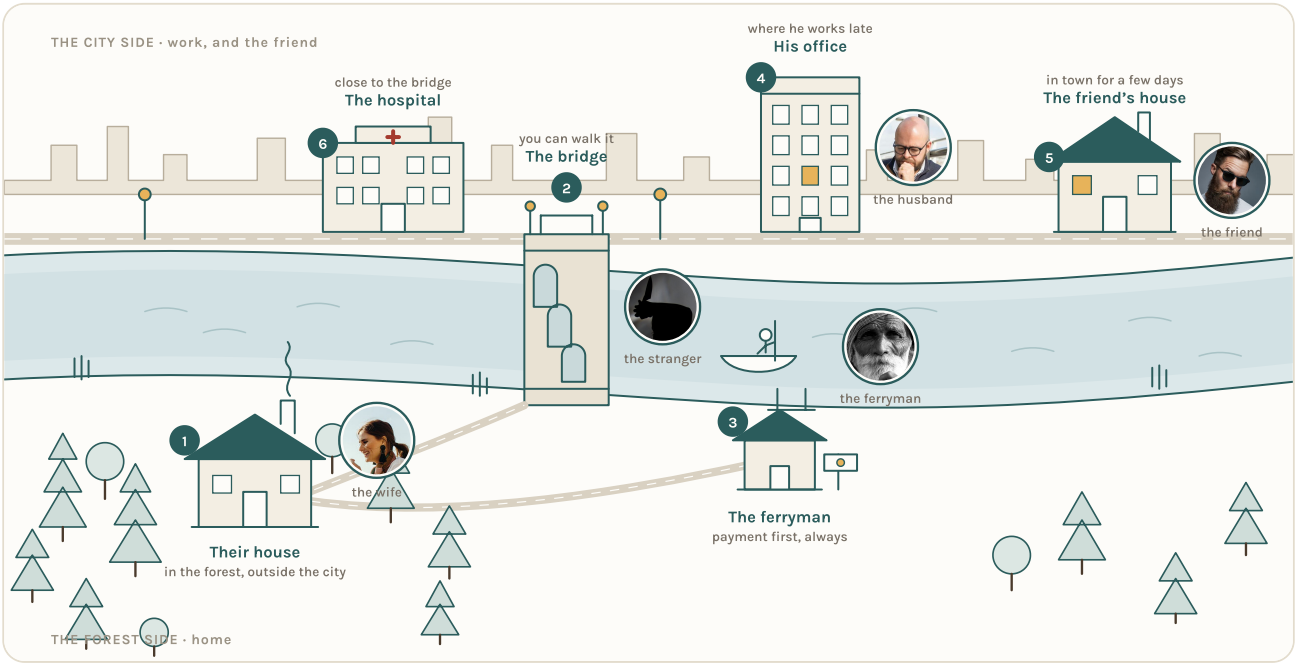
The bridge story

TASK 1

The story

Listen to your teacher's story. Follow it on the map.



Check the map.

1. How many ways are there across the river? _____

2. Can you walk across the bridge? _____

3. Does the ferryman take people for free? _____

The story: made up for this lesson, on the shape of 'The Alligator River Story' in Simon, S., Howe, L. and Kirschenbaum, H. (1972) *Values Clarification*. New York: Hart. Lesson and tasks: Ramy Sakr, for Connect Lite (2026).

TASK 2

Who is most responsible?

Think. Who is most responsible for what happened to her? **Tell** your partner why.



The wife
She left the house.



The husband
He worked through the night.



The friend
He let her walk home.



The ferryman
He refused to take her.



The stranger
He was on the bridge.

Write your reason in one sentence. Start with *If...*

TASK 3

What does it mean?

Read the sentence. **Answer** the questions.

If she <u>had stayed</u> at home, she <u>would have survived</u>.

1. Did she stay at home? _____
2. Did she leave the house? _____
3. Did she survive? _____
4. Is it about the past, now or the future? _____
5. Can anyone change what happened? _____
6. "She stayed at home": is that real or imaginary? _____

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TASK 4

The form

Complete the pattern.

If + subject + _____ **+** _____ **, subject +** _____ **+**

_____ **+** _____

If she had stayed at home, she would have survived. (comma)

She would have survived **if she had stayed at home.** (no comma)

she'd stayed = she **had** stayed · she'd have = she **would** have

Not: ~~If she would have stayed…~~

TASK 5

Say it

Listen and **repeat**, from the end of the sentence back to the start.

1. **survived**
2. **would have survived** /ˈwʊd əv səˈvaɪvd/
3. **she'd have survived**
4. **at home**
5. **stayed at home**
6. **if she'd stayed at home** /ɪf ʃid ˈsteɪd ət ˈhəʊm/
7. **If she'd STAYED at HOME, she'd have surVIVED.**

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TASK 6

Match the two halves

In pairs, match each beginning to its ending. Who says each sentence?

1. If she had stayed at home, _____
2. If I had had time for my wife, _____
3. If we hadn't bought that house, _____
4. If she had taken enough money, _____
5. If I hadn't kept filling her glass, _____
6. If I had taken her on my boat, _____
7. If I hadn't escaped from the hospital, _____
8. If she hadn't been so lonely, _____

a. she wouldn't have had to cross the bridge.
b. she wouldn't have been hurt.
c. she wouldn't have left so late.
d. I wouldn't have had to work so hard.
e. I wouldn't have had the chance to hurt her.
f. she would have been able to take the ferry.
g. I would have gone home to have dinner with her.
h. would she have left the house?

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TASK 7

Finish the sentences your way

Complete each sentence with *would / wouldn't have…* Then compare with a partner.

1. If she had found a job in the city,

2. If he hadn't worked every evening,

3. If they hadn't bought the house in the forest,

4. If she had taken some money with her,

5. If the ferryman had broken his promise,

6. If her husband had come home that night,

TASK 8

Rank them, and argue

Alone: rank the five from 1 (most responsible) to 5 (least). **Then in groups:** agree an order. You can only defend a position with *If…*

 The wife

 The husband

 The friend

 The ferryman

 The stranger

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TASK 9

The twist

After the ranking: each person in the story stands for something.
Your teacher will tell you what.



The wife



The husband



The friend



The ferryman



The stranger

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